

▲ By The Way...

Applesoft BASIC programs are treated as documents by the Finder—that's why they have the folded-down corner. The documents "belong" to the program named BASIC.System. See the next section for more on documents and how they can "belong" to application program.

Of course, System 6 can also run modern Desktop-based programs like AppleWorks GS. Icons for desktop programs have a tiny menu bar. Many such programs have names that end in "Sys16." There are also 16-bit programs that *don't* use the Desktop; they're indicated by the generic application icon—the plain diamond with the hand writing on it.

🔧 Note!

When you run an 8-bit SYS application, an Applesoft BASIC program, or a non-Desktop 16-bit program, you leave the Apple Desktop environment. Some programs mimic the Apple Desktop in part or in whole, but in general, each non-Desktop program is different.

Opening Documents

One of the Finder's most powerful features is its ability to open document files in the program that created them. If you double-click a document icon, the Finder will open it if it knows which program it "belongs" to. That is, the Finder will run the program that the document belongs to and tell it to open your document. (If the Finder doesn't know which program owns a document, it will display an "An Application Can't Be Found For This Document" alert.)

As shipped from Apple, the Finder knows only that BASIC programs belong to a program called BASIC.System, and that standard text files belong to a simple word processor (included with System 6) called Teach.

You tell the Finder about what documents go with which programs via icon files. Icon files contain special icons for the files that are associated with a program. They also contain the information the Finder needs to "link" the program and its documents. Many programs come with icon files; when you install such programs on your hard drive, you should also copy the program's icon file into the Icons folder on your hard drive.

⑥ New & Improved

Under System 6, it's possible for a programmer to include the icons within the application program. In that case, copying the program to your hard drive is all that's necessary—new icons for the program and its documents will appear automatically. More and more new programs will use this technique, making icon files a thing of the past.

Sometimes the Finder will know that a document goes with a particular program, but will be unable to find the program because the program isn't in the folder that the Finder is looking in, or because the disk the program is on isn't a drive. When this happens, the Finder will alert you that it can't find the program and permit you to Cancel, Try Again (after you've inserted the disk that contains the program), or Locate. If you choose Locate, a Standard File dialog appears so you can show the Finder where the program is. (We'll cover Standard File dialogs in the next chapter.) Once you've located a program for the Finder, the Finder remembers where the program is so that it knows how to open that kind of document in the future.